

Competency Framework for Independent Standard Work

The framework defines the observable progression and evidence required before a new engineer can be approved for independent standard technical work.

STANDARD TECHNICAL WORK ONLY

 Define what a learner must know, perform and demonstrate at increasing levels of support.

COMPETENCY DOMAIN	Level 1 — Knows	Level 2 — Performs with guidance	Level 3 — Performs with limited support	Level 4 — Performs independently
	Definition Explains the purpose, sequence and basic logic of standard work. Support not Observation, explanation and frequent prompting. Limitation Does not prove reliable task performance.	Definition Completes defined work with active direction and correction. Support not outine decisions are confirmed by another person. Limitation Not ready to work without active guidance.	Definition Completes standard work with targeted clarification or review. Support not upport is episodic rather than continuous. Limitation Repeatable independent performance is not yet established.	Definition Completes standard work without routine supervision. Support not upport is requested only for justified exceptions. Limitation Standard work only — not specialist authority.
01 Software and workflow knowledge Explains the software purpose, terminology, required inputs, outputs and standard workflow structure.	Explains the software purpose, terminology, inputs, outputs and standard workflow sequence.	Identifies required steps, inputs and outputs with trainer guidance for a standard task.	Explains workflow choices, required inputs, outputs and checks with targeted clarification.	Selects and justifies required workflow steps, inputs, outputs and checks without routine prompting.
02 Standard workflow execution Completes the approved standard workflow accurately, in sequence and with usable outputs.	Sequences the main workflow steps and identifies the expected output.	Completes defined workflow steps accurately with step-by-step direction and correction.	Completes the standard workflow with limited prompting and corrects identified errors.	Completes the full standard workflow accurately, consistently and without routine intervention.
03 Technical judgment and boundary recognition Makes routine technical decisions, explains rationale and recognizes when work exceeds the standard scope.	Identifies routine decisions, known limits and situations requiring escalation.	Makes routine choices after confirmation and escalates uncertainties when directed.	Makes routine decisions, explains rationale and escalates specific uncertainties appropriately.	Makes justified routine decisions and escalates work beyond the approved standard scope.
04 Result interpretation and quality control Interprets principal results, performs required checks and identifies evident anomalies before review.	Describes expected result patterns and identifies the required quality checks.	Performs prescribed checks with guidance and recognizes issues after prompting.	Interprets principal results, performs standard checks and identifies evident anomalies.	Verifies inputs and outputs, interprets results and identifies anomalies without routine prompting.
05 Documentation and traceability Records inputs, assumptions, decisions, outputs and review history in a traceable form.	Identifies required records, assumptions, file status and review information.	Documents assigned steps and updates records after prompted correction.	Records inputs, assumptions, decisions and results with limited correction.	Produces complete, traceable documentation and responds effectively to review comments.
06 Task ownership and escalation Plans assigned standard work, manages routine uncertainty, incorporates feedback and escalates genuine exceptions.	Describes task responsibilities, support routes and limits of the assigned standard scope.	Completes assigned portions, incorporates feedback and requests support when prompted.	Plans most task activities, manages routine uncertainty and requests specific support.	Owens the standard task, incorporates feedback and escalates genuine exceptions appropriately.

EVIDENCE BAND					
Knowledge evidence Shows what the learner can explain, sequence and recognize. Workflow explanation; terminology use; required-check identification. Primary: Domain 1	Performance evidence Shows execution of the standard workflow in representative work. Observed task; completed output; corrected workflow steps. Primary: Domain 2	Judgment evidence Shows decision rationale, boundary recognition and appropriate escalation. Decision record; identified uncertainty; correctly escalated exception. Primary: Domain 3	Interpretation and quality evidence Shows that results were interpreted and checked before review. Result explanation; quality-check record; identified anomaly. Primary: Domain 4	Documentation evidence Shows that inputs, decisions, outputs and review history are traceable. Work record; file and version identification; review response. Primary: Domain 5	Autonomy and escalation evidence Shows the support required and whether routine issues were handled appropriately. Support record; task without routine intervention; correctly escalated exception. Primary: Domain 6
No single evidence type establishes readiness.					

READINESS-DECISION LOGIC
Demonstrated level by domain Assign the highest level supported by observable evidence in each competency domain. Development need Identify the unmet behaviour, affected domain and further practice or support required. Independent-work readiness Approve independent standard work only when integrated Level 4 performance is demonstrated across all required domains.
Judgment, quality control, documentation and escalation barriers cannot be averaged away. Exact scoring and weighting belong to the later assessment system.

STAKEHOLDER RESPONSIBILITIES					
New Engineer Would perform representative work, explain decisions and retain required evidence.	Technical Trainer Would observe workflow performance, record support and provide structured feedback.	Senior Specialist Would validate technical judgment, interpretation and recognition of scope boundaries.	Engineering Manager Would define standard-work scope and make the readiness decision from available evidence.	Learning or Competency Lead Would support consistent interpretation and consolidate evidence where involved.	Project-Delivery Manager Would use the approved readiness status when allocating standard work.

CURRENT-STATE DIAGNOSIS	FRAMEWORK PURPOSE
Independent-work readiness cannot be verified consistently.	Independent standard work may be approved only when integrated performance is demonstrated across all required domains.